

Step 5

Acknowledge - Admit to God, ourselves, and someone else our wrong doings

- (James 5:16) says ***“Therefore, confess your sins (faults/side slip/error/lapse) to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed”***
- (Proverbs 28:13) says ***“Whoever conceals their sins does not prosper, but the one who confesses and renounces them finds mercy. ”***

Openly examine and confess my faults to myself, to God, and to someone I trust. *Happy are the pure and heart. Matthew 5:8*

Think about it

People often ask why they need to admit their wrongs to another person. There are three main reasons.

Why admit my wrongs?

1. *We gain healing that the Bible promises*

Look at James 5:16 again. God's word tells us that we are to admit our wrongs, our sins, to one another. You do this not to receive their forgiveness, for God has already forgave you when you confessed your wrongs and sins to him. James 5:16 says to confess your sins to one another for *healing*.

Sharing our secrets, struggles, and failures with another is part of God's plan of our healing process. The road to recovery is not meant to be walked alone.

2. *We gain freedom.*

Our secrets have kept us in chains, bound up, frozen, and unable to move in. All our relationships. Admitting our sins snaps the chains.

They cried to the Lord in their troubles, and he rescued them! He led them from the darkness and the shadow of death and snapped their chains. (Psalms 107:13-14 TLB)

3. *We gain support.*

When you share your inventory with another person, you get support. The person can keep you focused and provide feedback. He or she can challenge you. Most importantly, the person will listen!

How do I choose someone?

1. Choose someone of the same sex as you, whom you trust and respect.
2. Ask your mentor/sponsor/accountability partner. Just be sure that they understand and have been through or are going through the process themselves.
3. Most importantly, know that they are a believer and follower of Jesus Christ.

But if we confess our sins, he will forgive our sins, because we can trust God to do what is right. He will cleanse us from all the wrongs we have done (1John 1:9 NCV)

Write About It

1. **In Step 4, We learn to examine ourselves. Now we are asking to reveal what you found to someone else.** Who are we to confess it to and why?
2. Most of us find it easier to confess our wrongs to ourselves and God. We seem to have more difficulty in sharing them with another person. What is the most difficult part for you? Why?
3. What is your biggest fear of sharing your inventory or faults with another person?
4. List three people with whom you are considering sharing your inventory or thoughts with. List the pros and cons of each selection. Circle your final choice.

Now you're ready for one of the most free experiences of your life here on this earth! You will appreciate James 5:16 as never before. *Therefore, confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed.*

James 5:16 Admit your faults to one another and pray for each other so that you may be healed.

Colossians 2:13-15 You were dead in sins, and your sinful desires were not yet cut away. Then he gave you a share in the very life of Christ, for he forgave all your sins, **14** and blotted out the charges proved against you, the list of his commandments which you had not obeyed. He took this list of sins and destroyed it by nailing it to Christ's cross. **15** In this way God took away Satan's power to accuse you of sin, and God openly displayed to the whole world Christ's triumph at the cross where your sins were all taken away.

1 John 1:8-9 If we say that we have no sin, we are only fooling ourselves and refusing to accept the truth. **9** But if we confess our sins to him,^[a] he can be depended on to forgive us and to cleanse us from every wrong. And it is perfectly proper for God to do this for us because Christ died to wash away our sins.*

2 Corinthians 5:19 For God was in Christ, restoring the world to himself, no longer counting men's sins against them but blotting them out. This is the wonderful message he has given us to tell others.

Proverbs 28:13 A man who refuses to admit his mistakes can never be successful. But if he confesses and forsakes them, he gets another chance.

Romans 14:12 Yes, each of us will give an account of himself to God.

Psalms 32:3-5 There was a time when I wouldn't admit what a sinner I was.^[a] But my dishonesty made me miserable and filled my days with frustration. **4** All day and all night your hand was heavy on me. My strength evaporated like water on a sunny day **5** until I finally admitted all my sins to you and stopped trying to hide them. I said to myself, "I will confess them to the Lord." And you forgave me! All my guilt is gone.

Romans 8:1

So there is now no condemnation awaiting those who belong to Christ Jesus.